Name _____ Date ____ / ____ / _____

ENGLISH · THE SENTENCE · U1-L3

Simple Subjects and Simple Predicates

The homework half of the lesson. Circle the one word that runs each half, then strip a sentence down to two.

Part A — One word

____ / 6

Circle the single word the question asks for. Describing words are never the answer, however close to the verb they sit.

1. The tall antenna behind the office sways in the wind. **simple subject**
2. A student pilot in the first plane taxis toward the numbers. **simple predicate**
3. The green fuel drum beside the shed leaks a little. **simple subject**
4. Two visitors near the gate photograph the yellow biplane. **simple predicate**
5. A folding chair under the wing holds somebody's coffee. **simple subject**
6. The mechanic's daughter counts the planes on the ramp. **simple predicate**

Part B — Down to two words

____ / 5

Write the simple subject and the simple predicate for each sentence. Then read those two words on their own and check that they still make sense together.

1. The oldest plane on the field starts on the second try.

   Simple subject _____ Simple predicate _____

2. A row of orange cones marks the edge of the apron.

   Simple subject _____ Simple predicate _____

3. The chief mechanic's radio crackles all morning.

   Simple subject _____ Simple predicate _____

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4. Two dogs behind the fuel shed bark at every engine.

   Simple subject _____ Simple predicate _____

5. A thin line of cloud hides the far end of the runway.

   Simple subject _____ Simple predicate _____

Part C — Write your own

_____ / 2

Write a sentence of your own on the first line, then write its two words underneath.

1. A sentence about anything you like _____

   Its two words _____

2. A longer sentence, with a phrase in the middle _____

   Its two words _____

Total _____ / 13

Graded by _____

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Answer key

Part A — the word that should be circled.

1. antenna
2. taxis
3. drum
4. photograph
5. chair
6. counts

Part B — subject, then predicate.

1. plane · starts
2. row · marks
3. radio · crackles
4. dogs · bark
5. line · hides

Part C — answers vary. The simple subject should be one noun or pronoun, never a describing word beside it, and the simple predicate should be the verb. If the two words they write do not make sense read on their own, they picked a word out of the describing phrase.

Say the sentence with only those two words. If it still stands up on its own, you found them.

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